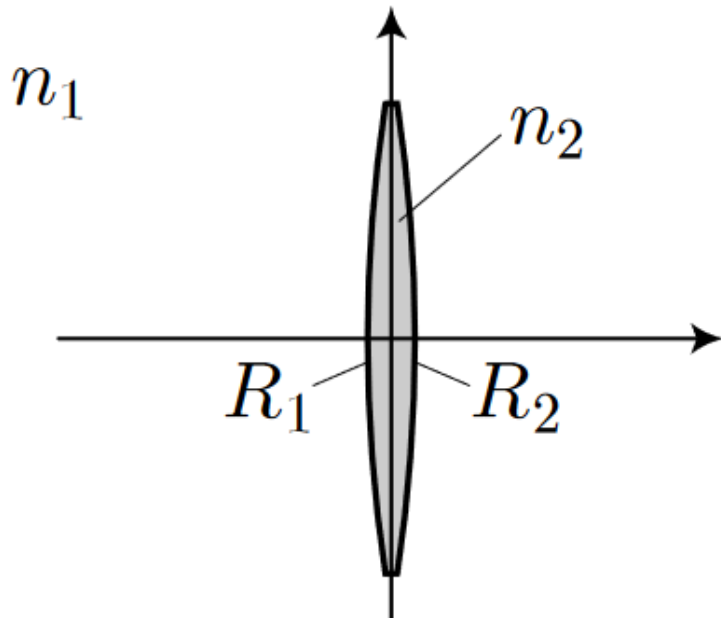


# Ph134, Lecture 14

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- **Thin lenses:**
  - **Lensmaker's equation**
  - **Converging and diverging lenses**
  - **Thin lens equation**
- **Imaging with systems of lenses:**
  - **Real and virtual images**
  - **Real and virtual objects**
  - **It's all about how the rays are pointing!**

# ABCD matrix for thin lens:



$$\mathbf{M} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ \frac{(n_2 - n_1)}{n_1} \left( \frac{1}{R_2} - \frac{1}{R_1} \right) & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$



$$R_1 > 0, R_2 < 0$$



$$R_1 < 0, R_2 > 0$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ -\frac{1}{f} & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$f$  is the **focal length** of the lens.

$$\frac{1}{f} = \frac{(n_2 - n_1)}{n_1} \left( \frac{1}{R_1} - \frac{1}{R_2} \right)$$

the lensmaker's equation

# What does the focal length mean?

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ -\frac{1}{f} & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} y_{in} \\ \theta_{in} \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} y_{in} \\ \theta_{in} - \frac{y_{in}}{f} \end{bmatrix}$$

*$f > 0$ ? Lens bends incoming rays  
TOWARD the optical axis:  
Converging lens*

*$f < 0$ ? Lens bends incoming rays  
AWAY FROM the optical axis:  
Diverging lens*

*Smaller magnitude of  $f$  means lens  
bends rays more.*

# **Converging ( $f > 0$ ) and diverging ( $f < 0$ ) lenses in air:**

$$\frac{1}{f} = (n - 1) \left( \frac{1}{R_1} - \frac{1}{R_2} \right)$$

*Light incident on convex surface:  $R > 0$*

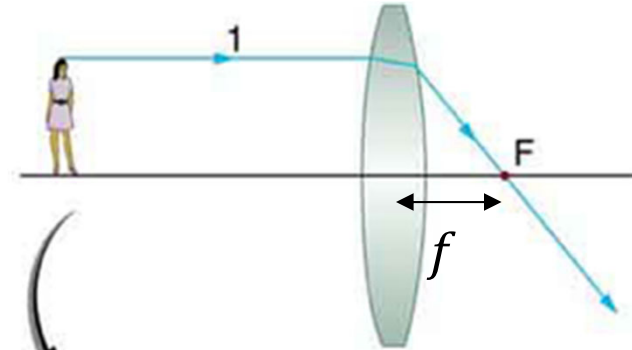
*Light incident on concave surface:  $R < 0$*



# Ray-tracing rules

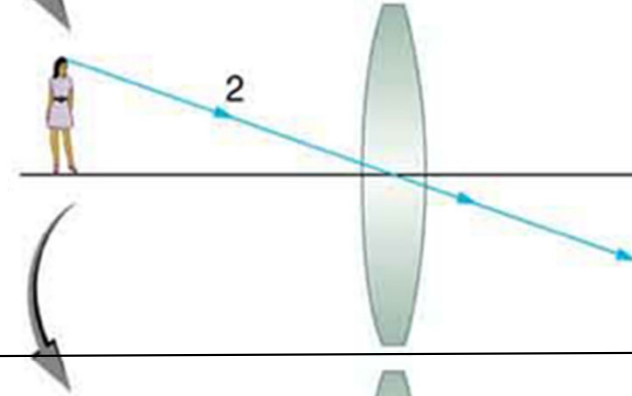
*Incoming ray parallel to OA?*

*Outgoing ray intersects OA  
at  $f$  downstream of lens*



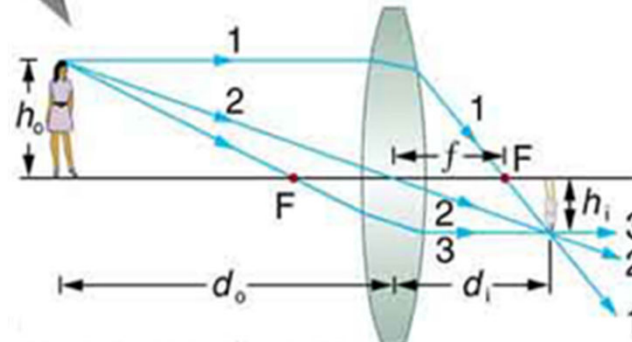
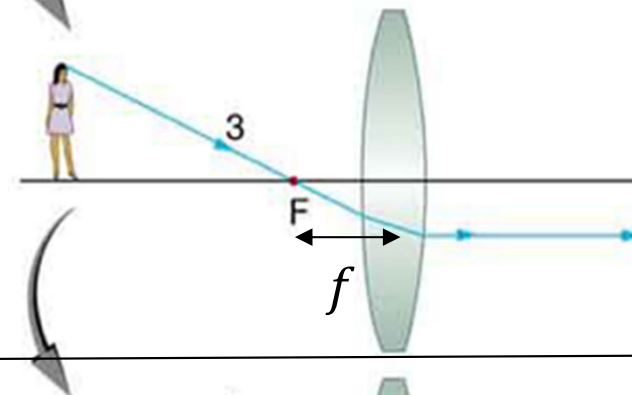
*Incoming ray through OA?*

*Outgoing ray not deflected.*



*Incoming ray intersects OA  
at  $f$  upstream of lens?*

*Outgoing ray parallel to OA*

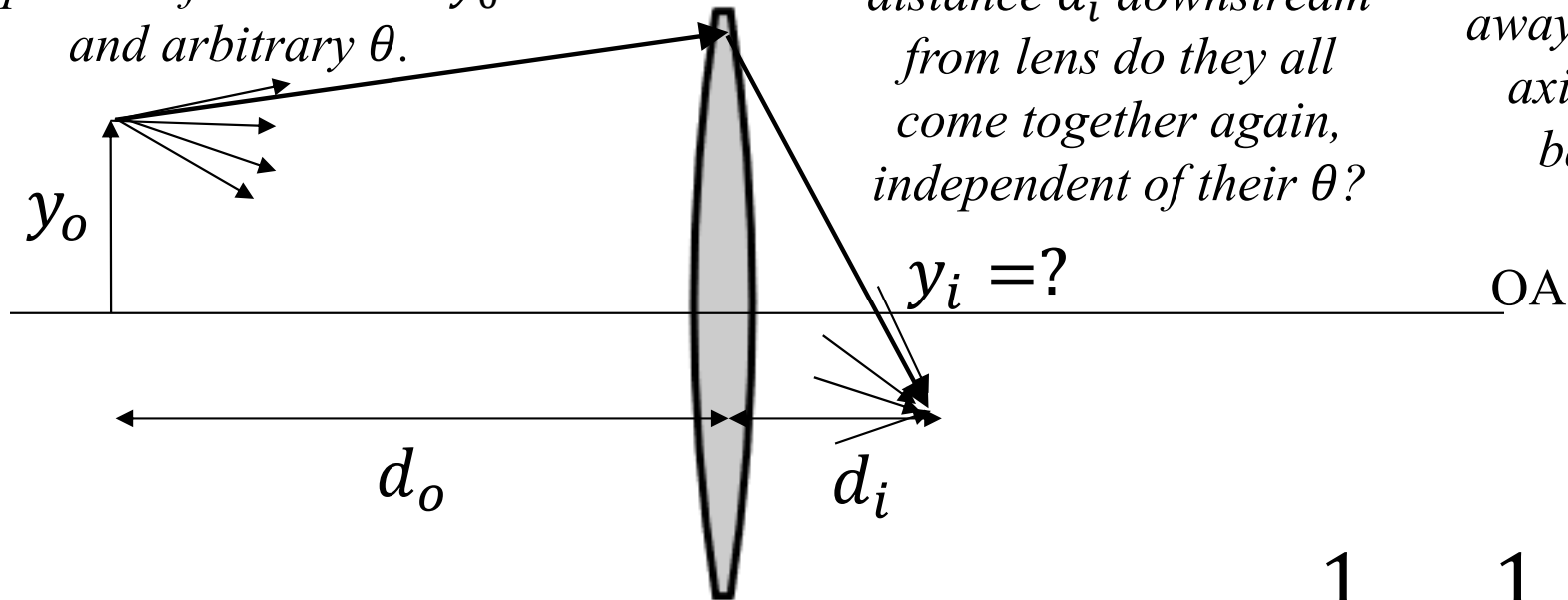


# Thin lens equation and magnification:

Consider rays that start  
longitudinal distance  $d_o$   
upstream from lens at  $y_o$   
and arbitrary  $\theta$ .

At what longitudinal  
distance  $d_i$  downstream  
from lens do they all  
come together again,  
independent of their  $\theta$ ?

At what position  
away from the optical  
axis do they come  
back together?



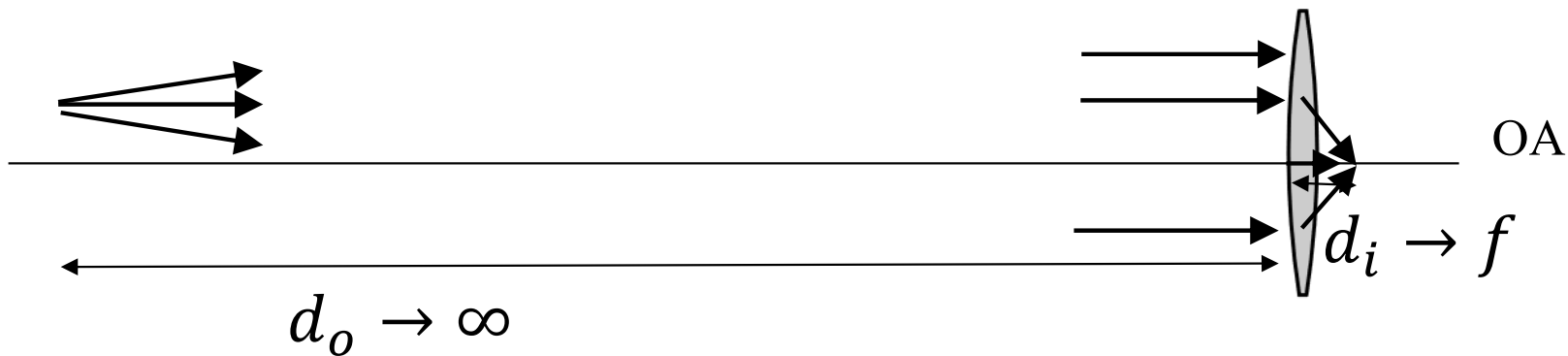
$$\frac{1}{f} = \frac{1}{d_o} + \frac{1}{d_i}$$

Magnification  $\frac{y_i}{y_o} = -\frac{d_i}{d_o}$

**Is the focal point the place where the lens forms a focused image? Only if the object being imaged is infinitely far away!**

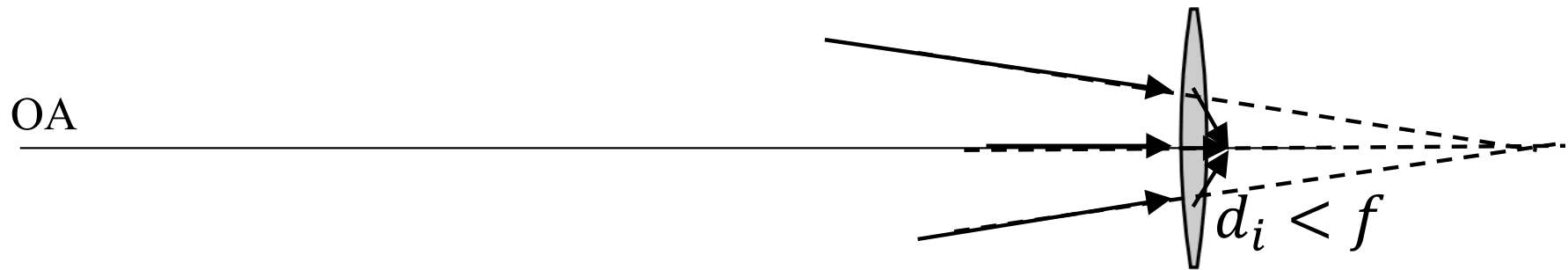
$$\frac{1}{f} = \frac{1}{d_o} + \frac{1}{d_i}$$

*An object at infinite distance will be imaged at  $f$  downstream from the lens.*



*Or: an incoming collimated beam (a beam with near-planar wavefronts) will be focused to a spot at  $f$  downstream from the lens.*

**Can we put the object farther away than  $\infty$  ?**



$$\frac{1}{f} = \frac{1}{d_o} + \frac{1}{d_i}$$

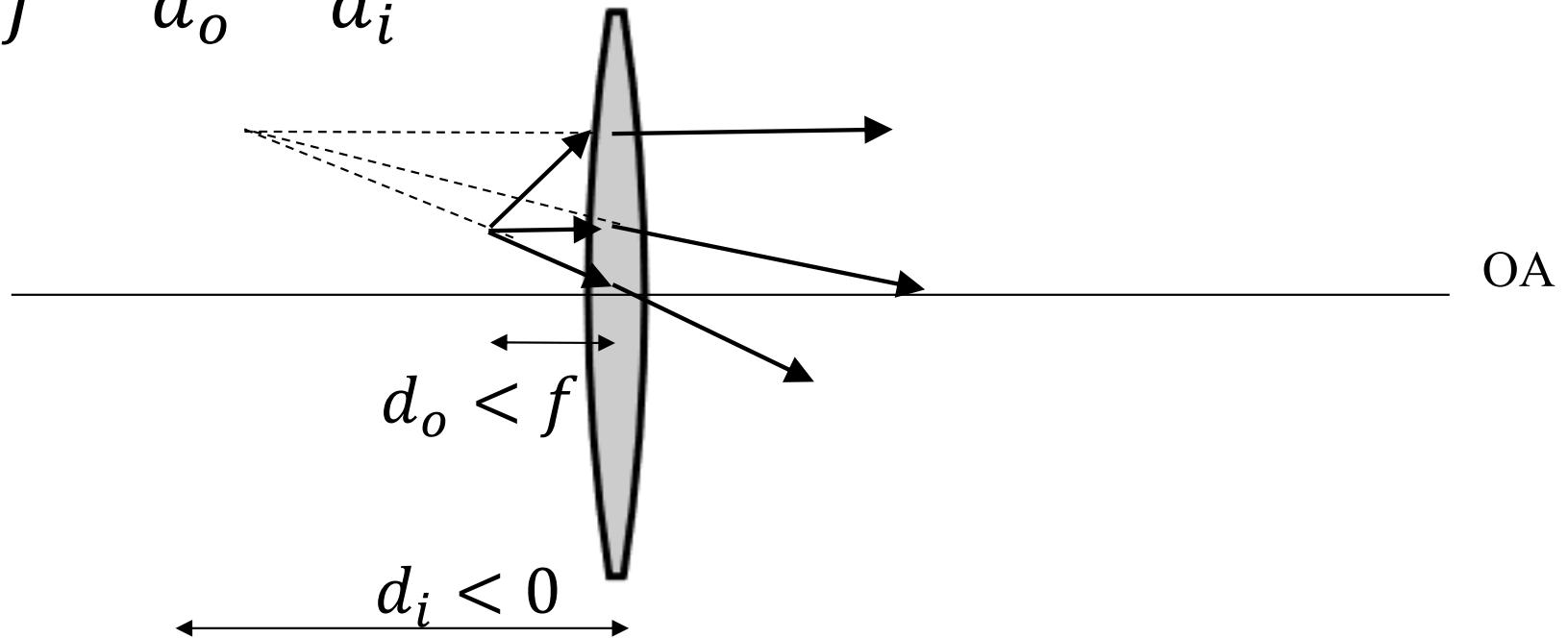
$$d_o < 0$$

*Rays incident on lens are already converging  
– on path as if coming from object at a  
position DOWNSTREAM of the lens.*



**We tried huge  $d_o$ ... what about tiny?**

$$\frac{1}{f} = \frac{1}{d_o} + \frac{1}{d_i}$$



*Nothing at the image position, no light propagating “back” to it.  
But rays downstream of lens look like they came from that spot.*

## **Real and virtual images:**

*Real image: downstream of lens.  $d_i > 0$*

*Light rays coming from lens actually pass through image pos'n.*

*Virtual image: upstream of lens.  $d_i < 0$*

*Light rays coming from lens are angled as if they pass through image pos'n.*

## **Real and virtual objects:**

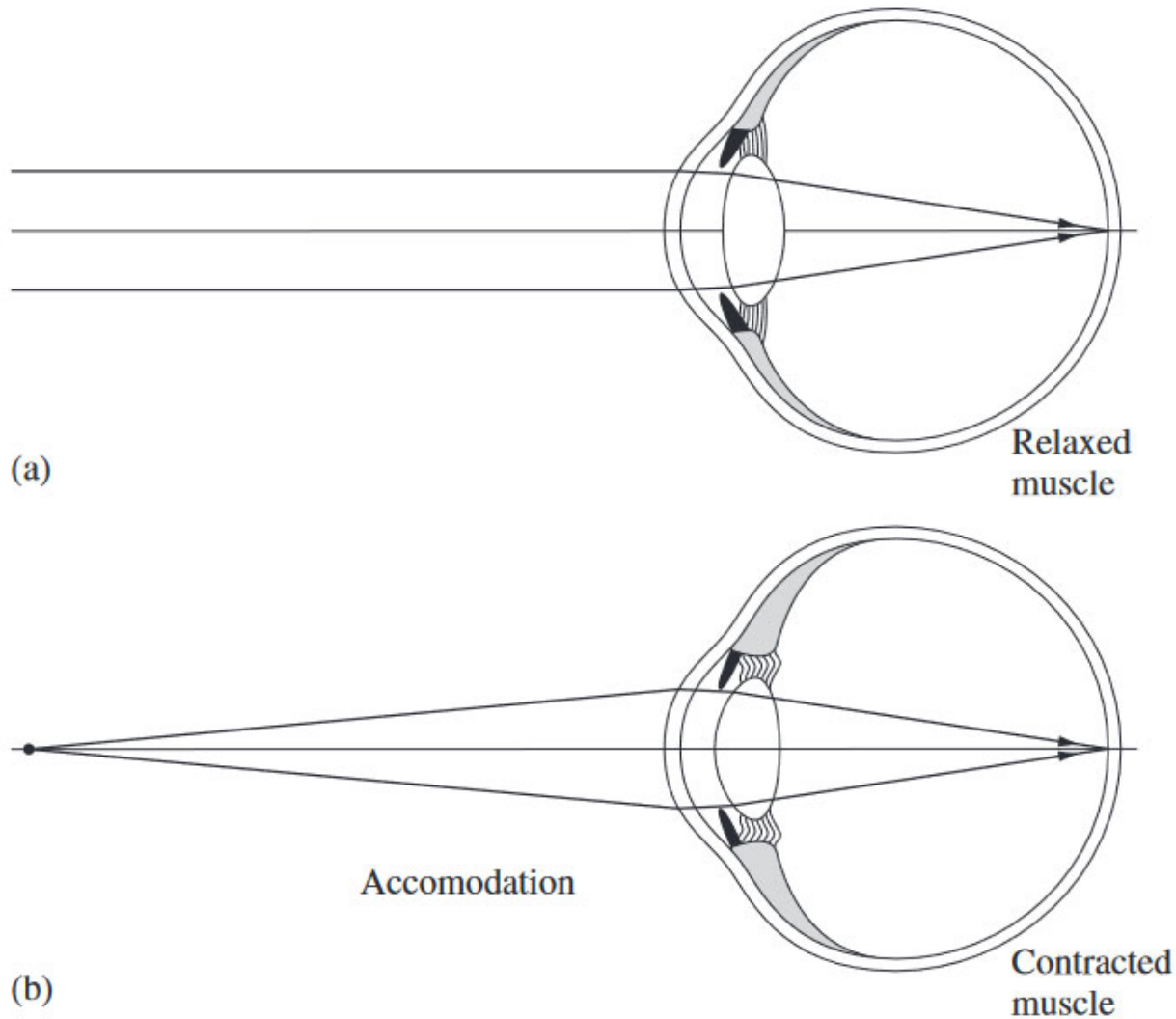
*Real object: upstream of lens.  $d_o > 0$*

*Light rays incident on lens actually come directly from each point on the object.*

*Virtual object: downstream of lens.  $d_o < 0$*

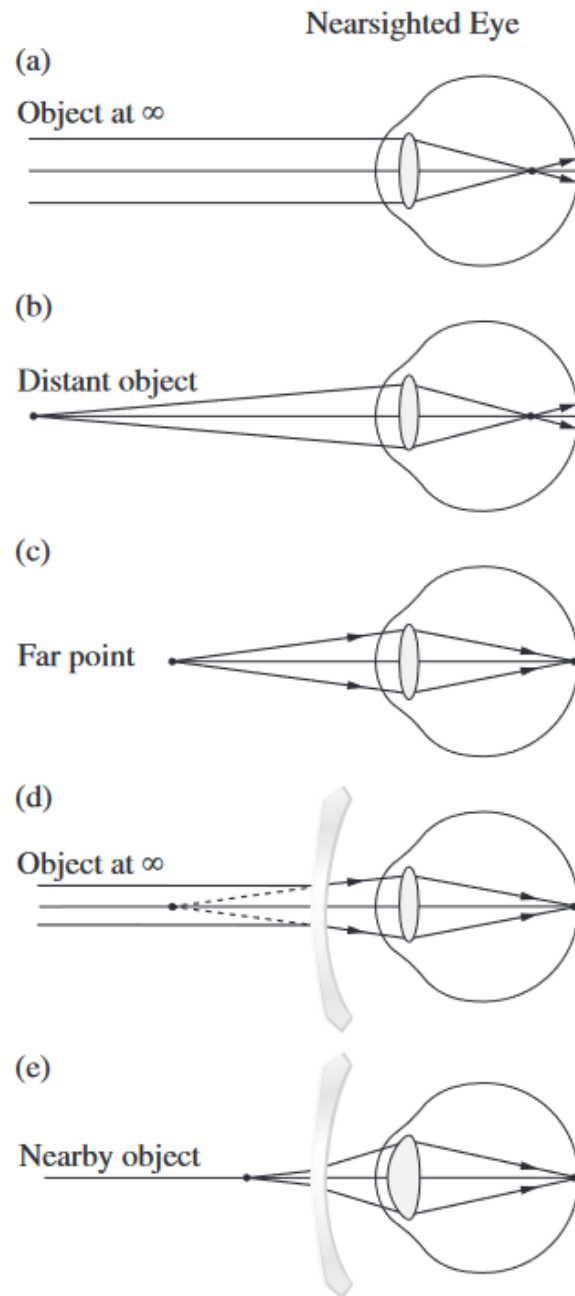
*Light rays incident on lens are angled as if they are converging on (or if time reversed, diverging from) the "object."*

# The human eye and corrective lenses:



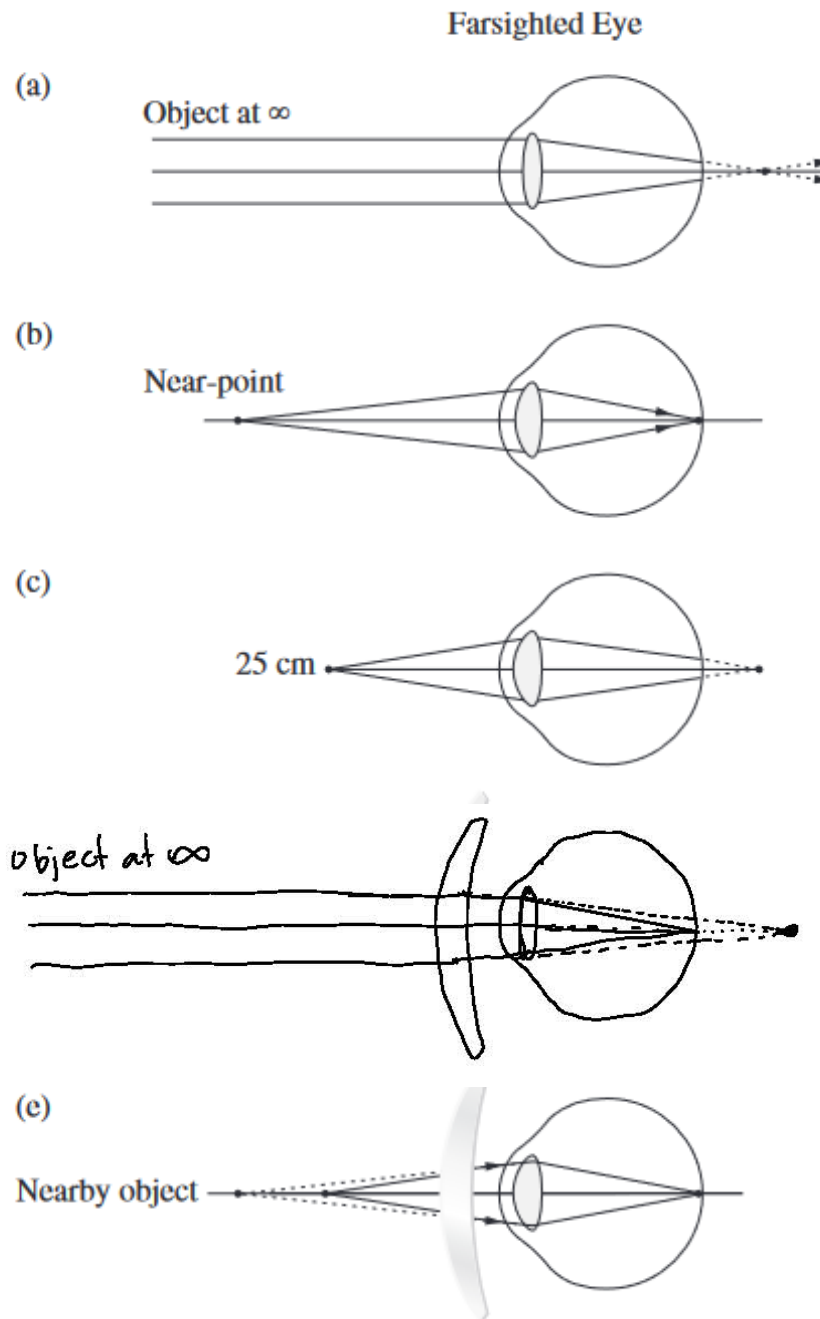
**Figure 5.93** Accommodation—changes in the lens configuration.

# The human eye and corrective lenses:



*Figures from Hecht, Optics*

# The human eye and corrective lenses:



*Figures adapted from Hecht, Optics*